

course/prep

cuisine/chinese

effort/easy

form/staple

Chinese Five Spice Powder

Ingredients

Ingredient	Amount
Star anise, whole	6 pods
Fennel seeds	2 tbsp
Sichuan peppercorns	2 tsp
Cinnamon stick (Asian/cassia; Western cinnamon stick may be substituted if unavailable)	1 stick
Cloves	2 tsp

Procedure

1. Lightly crush the star anise and cinnamon stick with a mortar and pestle (or similar) into pieces roughly 1 cm or smaller.
2. Toast all the spices together in a dry pan over medium heat, stirring, until you notice some smoke.
3. Let the toasted spices cool.
4. Grind to a fine powder.
5. Store in an airtight container.

Notes

- Make in small batches — this maximizes the aroma of the finished powder.
- Check your spices before starting: if they're old or don't smell strongly on their own, the finished five spice powder won't be as fragrant.